Product Management and Agentic AI - Masai School

Piyush J Kundnani - Module A Project

Smart Shopping Companion – Guided Retail Experience for Amazon

1. The Product You Chose

Product: Amazon (E-commerce)

Why I Picked It:

Despite its massive convenience and product range, Amazon lacks the humanized retail-like experience. In physical stores, especially for elders or rural users, a salesperson helps customers choose products based on mood, occasion, or budget—something Amazon fails to replicate. This personal touch is missing, leading to frustration or indecisiveness for many users, especially non-tech-savvy shoppers.

2. Product Vision

"To be Earth's most customer-centric company, where customers can find and discover anything they might want to buy online."

(Source: Amazon's Leadership Principles / Official Brand Statement)

3. Product Mission

Amazon provides a seamless, reliable, and convenient online shopping experience by offering extensive product variety, competitive pricing, rapid delivery, and easy returns, empowering customers worldwide.

4. Problem Statement

When I shop on Amazon, I want to easily select products suited to my occasion, mood, or budget, but I struggle because Amazon lacks personalized assistance or human-like

guidance, leading to confusion, frustration, wasted time, and reduced confidence in my purchase decisions.

5. Jobs-To-Be-Done (JTBD)

Help me confidently choose and purchase the right product quickly, so I can feel assured that I'm making the best possible decision for my needs, mood, occasion, or budget.

6. User Research Plan

Objective

To validate that certain user segments—particularly elders, rural/semi-urban users, and potentially confused online shoppers—face difficulties in making confident purchase decisions on Amazon due to lack of guided, personalized assistance.

Target User Segments & Justification

User Segment	Why They Were Chosen
Elders (50+ years old)	Typically less tech-savvy, they often require assistance from family for online purchases.
Rural/Semi-urban Users	Prefer physical retail due to trust, familiarity, and direct product interactions.

User Segment	Why They Were Chosen
Confused Online Shoppers	Based on early personal observations, these users often know what they want in general but get overwhelmed by options, reviews, or price points—leading to indecision or cart abandonment. This segment is currently a working hypothesis and will be validated through research.

Research Methods:

1. User Interviews

- Sample Size: 5–7 users
- Goal: Understand behavior, needs, pain points, and emotional friction during shopping

2. Surveys

- Sample Size: 20–30 users across segments
- Goal: Quantify frequency of decision fatigue, product selection issues, and trust challenges

Sample Questions

Interview Questions:

1. "Do you prefer shopping online (like on Amazon) or visiting a physical retail store, and what influences your choice?"
Purpose: Understand motivations and emotional needs behind the shopping channel preference.

2. "Which of the following best describes your online shopping behavior?"
a) **Planned shopper** – Knows what they want and buys directly.
b) **Confused shopper** – Has a need but feels unsure about what brand/product/price to choose.
c) **Window shopper** – Browses casually, often buying impulsively or based on mood.

Purpose: Categorize users based on their clarity and confidence in the online purchase process.

Survey Question:

"Do you often find that buying products online (like on Amazon) requires significant planning or time to figure out what product or brand best suits your need, mood, or occasion?"

- ☐ Yes, frequently
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Never

Purpose: Quantify the emotional and decision-making pain point and assess its severity across a broader user base.

7. Persona Snapshot

Attribute	Meena Devi – Dependent Shopper	Rakesh Patel – Confused Festival Shopper	Shruti Jain – Impulsive Urban Buyer
Age	61	36	27
Location	Rural Uttar Pradesh	Vadodara, Gujarat	Mumbai, Maharashtra
Tech Comfort	Low	Medium	High
Occupation	Homemaker	Small Business Owner	Marketing Professional
Goals	Buy essentials or family gifts	Shop for occasions like festivals	Discover exciting or mood-based items
Pain Points	Needs help to place orders Feels overwhelmed Distrusts listings	Compares endlessly Uncertain about value Fears wrong choices	Impulse buyer Overwhelmed by options Regrets purchases
Behavioral Insight	Avoids Amazon unless guided	Wants someone to simplify decisions	Needs personalized or curated discovery

8. Customer Journey Map (CJM) – Rakesh Patel

Stage	User Action	Emotion	Pain Point / Barrier
1. Need Recognition	Decides to buy gifts for Diwali	Excited	—
2. Product Search	Types “Diwali gifts” into Amazon and starts browsing	Overwhelmed	Too many results, not sure what suits budget, brand confusion
3. Evaluation	Opens 5–6 tabs to compare price, brand, reviews	Confused	Doesn’t trust reviews; no expert guidance or filter for gift mood/occasion
4. Decision Making	Reads reviews, checks deals, still unsure	Frustrated	Feels lost; spends too much time thinking about alternatives
5. Purchase	Picks one product randomly after 30+ mins	Hesitant	No confidence in decision; fear of having made the wrong choice
6. Post-Purchase	Waits for product; unsure whether it’s actually good	Anxious	No personal assurance like in a physical store or from a salesperson

9. Opportunity Sizing

Top-Down Market Sizing (TAM–SAM–SOM)

Level	Description	Estimated Size
TAM (Total Addressable Market)	**All online shoppers in India**	**~200 million**
SAM (Serviceable Available Market)	**Regular Amazon India users**	**~120 million**
SOM (Serviceable Obtainable Market)	**Users affected by decision fatigue or lack of guidance**	**~25–30 million (≈ 20–25% of SAM)**

Bottom-Up Estimation

Assumptions:

- 1% of SOM adopts the Smart Shopping Companion in Year 1 = ~250,000 users

- Average uplift in spend = ₹1,000 per year per user
  (Example: 1–2 additional confident purchases)

Potential Revenue Uplift:

₹25 crores annually (~$30M USD)

10. Prioritization – MoSCoW Framework

Feature	Priority	Why?
AI Guided Shopping Assistant	Must Have	Directly addresses the core user problem: lack of guidance & decision fatigue
Contextual Search Results	Must Have	Helps users express their need naturally and reduces confusion
Mood-Based Category Page	Should Have	Adds emotional engagement and discovery, but not essential to validate
Voice Support (Regional)	Should Have	Enhances accessibility for non-English users, especially in rural areas
Gamified Reviews	Could Have	Boosts engagement but does not solve the primary user pain point

11. MVP Idea – Smart Shopping Companion

To bridge the gap between the retail-like human guidance and Amazon's self-service interface, we propose a **Smart Shopping Companion** MVP—an assistant that recommends products based on occasion, mood, and budget.

This MVP focuses on providing curated product suggestions through a guided flow to help users make confident purchase decisions with less effort and confusion.

MVP Features

Feature	Description
Mini Q&A Prompt	2–3 simple questions: *"What's the occasion?"*, *"Budget?"*, *"Who is it for?"*
Curated Recommendations	Show 5–10 relevant products based on responses
Mood-Based Tabs	Display basic tabs like *"Gifting"*, *"Relaxation"*, *"Festive"*, *"Useful"*
Fallback to Standard Search	Let users skip the assistant and continue browsing normally
Feedback Prompt	*"Did these suggestions help you?"* to collect initial validation insights

Validation Metrics:

- % of users who use the assistant
- Add-to-cart/conversion from suggestions
- Feedback scores or comments

What's Excluded (for MVP):

- Voice input
- Personalized recommendations based on past purchases
- Machine learning or real-time contextual AI

Visual Wireframes – MVP Flow

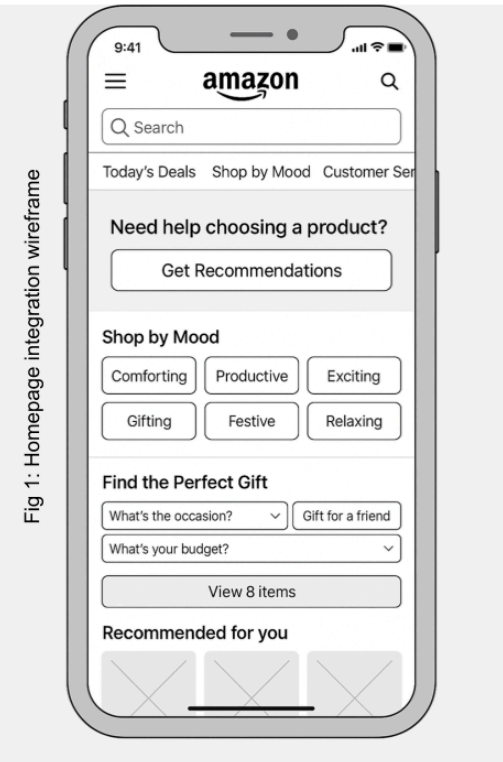

Fig 1: Homepage integration wireframe

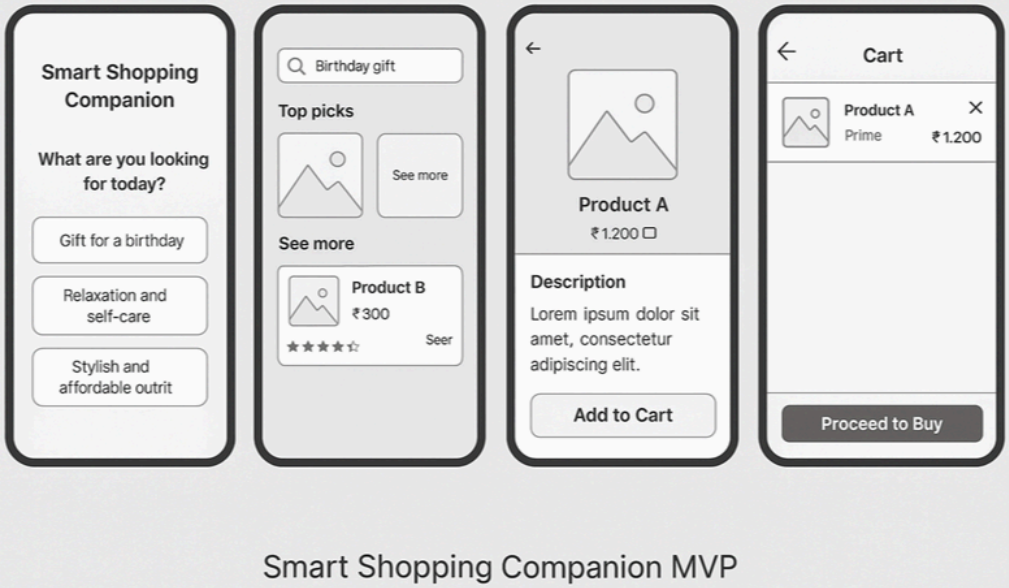

Fig 2: Guided prompt + recommendations shown on mobile UI

12. Roadmap Format – Now, Next, Later

Now (0–1 Month)

🎯 *Goal: Validate the concept with a lightweight MVP*

- Launch **Q&A-based Guided Shopping Assistant MVP**
- Add **4–5 mood-based shopping categories** (e.g. Gifting, Relaxing, Productive, Festive)
- Collect basic **feedback** from users post-interaction

- Track engagement: click-through, add-to-cart, and satisfaction scores

Next (1–3 Months)

🎯 *Goal: Expand reach, accuracy, and inclusivity*

- Introduce **Contextual Search Enhancements**
  (e.g., "gift for sister's wedding" → smart filters)
- Add **regional language prompts** (Hindi + 1 regional language)
- Expand mood playlists (e.g. "Rainy Day", "Heartbreak Recovery")
- Run **A/B test** of guided flow vs. standard flow

Later (3–6 Months)

🎯 *Goal: Personalization & voice accessibility*

- Add **voice input** for non-English speakers
- Personalize mood/occasion suggestions based on:
  - User behavior
  - Location
  - Purchase history
- Integrate Smart Assistant into **Alexa & mobile homepage**
- Launch during festive campaigns (e.g., Prime Day, Diwali)

13. Bonus: AI Thinking – Applying Agentic AI to Smart Shopping Companion

AI Component	How It Enhances the Experience
Natural Language Processing (NLP)	Understands contextual queries like “gift for 10-year-old nephew under ₹500” or “eco-friendly bathroom cleaner”
Recommendation Engine	Learns user preferences and suggests personalized products based on previous interactions, mood, or time of year
Sentiment Analysis	Analyzes user feedback (“Not helpful” vs. “Loved it!”) to refine recommendation quality
Dynamic Mood Curation	AI monitors shopping behavior, trends, and seasons to auto-generate mood-based categories (e.g., "Comfort Food Week")
Voice AI	Enables natural, language-inclusive voice-based queries for Tier 2/3 markets and elders

Agentic AI Potential (Long-Term Vision)

A truly intelligent assistant that **proactively learns** user intent, adapts to emotions or cultural context, and can eventually act on behalf of the user—like saying,
“Looks like you’re shopping for a festival gift again. Need suggestions under ₹1000?”

Conclusion

Through this project, we identified a critical yet often overlooked gap in the Amazon shopping experience—**the absence of personalized, guided assistance**, especially for users who are overwhelmed by choices or not confident navigating digital interfaces.

We proposed a **Smart Shopping Companion** as a solution—an AI-powered assistant that mimics the experience of a helpful store representative by offering product suggestions based on **mood, occasion, or budget**.

Using tools like:

- **User Research**
- **Persona Development**
- **Customer Journey Mapping**
- **Opportunity Sizing**
- **MoSCoW Prioritization**
- and an **MVP-first approach**,

We showed how this feature could be validated early and scaled using AI technologies such as NLP, recommendation engines, and sentiment analysis.

This solution not only supports Amazon's product vision of being the most customer-centric company on Earth, but also **bridges the emotional gap** between online convenience and retail confidence—helping users shop smarter, faster, and more meaningfully.